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Wayne Andre

Trombonist and arranger Wayne Andre was born in Manchester, Connecticut on November 17, 1931. He toured and recorded with big bands led by Charlie Spivak, Woody Herman and Benny Goodman and played an important role in the Kai Winding Septet. Wayne has been a first call trombonist in the New York City recording scene for three decades and currently arranges for a variety of ensembles across the country.

Wayne was interviewed in New York City on January 7, 2002 by Monk Rowe, Director of the Fillius Jazz Archive.

MR: My name is Monk Rowe and we are filming in Manhattan for the Hamilton College Jazz Archive. I'm very pleased to have veteran trombonist Wayne Andre with me.

WA: Thank you.

MR: Welcome.

WA: Pleased to be here and honored to be here.

MR: Well it's a pleasure to meet you. And I'm wondering what it's like in 2002 to be a full time trombonist in New York City.

WA: For me not too bad because I have a good pension. But for younger players it's a scuffle. Are you talking about the music business in general or are you talking about the jazz music business?

MR: You know I'm talking about in general right now.

WA: In general. I think I've never seen it worse. We've been killed for many years by synthetic music and California, which does the majority of the movies — they don't do all of them but they do probably 95% of the movies — the movies have kind of gotten away from synthetic music. You know what I mean by synthetic music, don't you?

MR: Sure.

WA: Music made by synthesizers. Music that doesn't breathe. I hate it.

MR: Yeah, that's a good—

WA: I mean it has its place in a certain place, but it's like when I do a jazz gig or whatever with electric piano, the thing I don't like about it is the instrument never seems to breathe. I like to hear space in music.

MR: Right. There's no silence at all.

WA: Yeah. And there's no nuance either, particularly with volume. You don't hear pianissimo, you don't hear forte, you just hear this one blaring sound all the time. But this is my observation on hearing it. But to get back to the business, I think I'm playing as well today as I've ever played in my life but I must be honest, the recording business in New York City, and the theater business — I wouldn't want to do a Broadway show anyway

— but the thing is most of it is geared toward younger musicians. As well it should be. I had my time. And I think I'm capable and qualified to do a lot more but I'm saying a lot of younger leaders come in and they've got their guys so to speak and with the older leaders that I work for kind of drift off and I might be still playing but they're not still writing so I sit home and I'm not working that much, quite frankly, at all. But I'm doing a lot of writing. I have my own band and I'm enjoying life. I'm in a nice place.

MR: Had you decided at a fairly early age that music was going to be your career?

WA: Yes I did as a matter of fact. I can start at the beginning if you want. I don't want to get too lengthy with this. I can get lengthy but, I came home from public school I think in the fourth or fifth grade and they had passed out this piece of paper about taking an instrument and a group thing and everything else. I said to my dad I says, "Oh I think maybe I'd like to do the trumpet or the drums." Something like that. I can't remember — I think I'm sure I showed enthusiasm, but my father loved music so if I wasn't enthusiastic he certainly was. And he said to me, "Trumpet players are a dime a dozen. Play the trombone." And I'll tell you, for the better part — not so much today — but for the better part of my career he was right. And so my mother went down to a pawn shop in Hartford, Connecticut and bought me a $25 — I had a rental horn at the school and then she went down to this pawn shop and bought me a $25 trombone in a pawn shop. And I had that for the longest time. But yeah, I remember, it's interesting you say that because I had a teacher in Hartford, Connecticut who had been in Gene Krupa's band, Bill Cully, and I remember saying to him one time, I says, "You know, Bill, you know I really love this. You think I can make a living at it?" He says, "Well sure." And of course I didn't know whether I could or not.

MR: What kind of music was played in your house when you were a kid?

WA: Well the first record my father brought home when we got a turntable was "Ain't Nobody Here But Us Chickens" by Louis Jordan. And I played the death out of that. I loved it. And then later, and my father loved Johann Strauss, he loved German waltzes and stuff like that so he bought some of those records and we heard some of that. And that's about as heavy as the classical music got in my house at the time. And then we kind of graduated, I kind of graduated to, I graduated to Tommy Dorsey and then to Woody Herman, Stan Kenton, Count Basie — although I must be honest about it, the one thing lacking in those days for me at the age of 17 as I was listening to all these bands, and much to my regret today, I didn't go out of my way or maybe even have the knowledge of going out of my way and hearing a lot of Duke Ellington. Maybe it wasn't that available in my record store. I don't remember. But I remember I was really into mostly Basie and Woody Herman, Stan Kenton, and some small — Kai Winding.

MR: Who you ended up working with.

WA: Yeah.
MR: That's interesting.
WA: Yeah.
MR: And I see you did some study at the Schillinger House?
WA: Yeah.
MR: I've seen that name come up a lot.
WA: You see it come up a lot?
MR: Yeah.
WA: Because not many people know the name.
MR: Really?
WA: But that's what it was called when I went there. It's now the Berklee School of Music.
MR: Right.
WA: Yeah, it's interesting. Because my mother took me up to Boston, I was 17 years old, and I auditioned for this fellow Ken McKillup, who was like the assistant to Larry Berk. And they gave me a full scholarship. And I can't remember the details. I had a full scholarship. I didn't pay any tuition, based on my audition I guess, and I don't know if that would have applied to the second, third or fourth year of the school or not but once I got out of the school the first year I ended up going on the road and I never went back you know. I mean it's one of those things.
MR: It happens frequently with the better players.
WA: Yeah. Well I went with Charlie Spivak's band and then — oh and then I got into the Korean War so I was in the service.
MR: Pardon? The Korean War?
WA: The Korean War, yeah. I was in the Air Force during the Korean War.
MR: Early fifties.
WA: So that took up like three years and nine months of my time. I got out early by three months.
MR: Did you do music in the service?
WA: Oh yeah. Yeah. As a matter of fact that's where I first started to write. I started writing in the service mainly through the small tools that I had learned at the Schillinger House. And I mean they seem so simple today, but they were such invaluable tools, you know, and then I would start copying a lot of records, like I remember taking "Four Others" off the record and how I would do is I would figure out what the harmony is, then I could hear if it was closed or open voicing, and I could hear that and I could kind of hear the bottom and the top. But I couldn't hear everything in between. So I'd figure out the harmony. So I'd kind of put an arrangement together. And whether I got the exact notes or not really doesn't matter, as long as it sounded the same. Like I think in "Four Others,"

which I kind of liked better — blowing my own horn now — [scats] I think the second chord I use in "Four Others," I use an E seventh chord and I think Jimmy Giuffre used a B flat half diminished.

MR: Okay.

WA: You know what I'm saying?

MR: They're fairly close.

WA: It's fairly close but, if you think about it you know, but it still has that dominant sound anyway. But that's how I learned how to write. And a lot of my writing, and I think a lot of people's writing today is you learn by analysis. I went to Manhattan School of Music and I learned more about music in an analysis course than anyplace else I think you know.

MR: It helps too to have people to play your stuff.

WA: Oh yeah.

MR: Fairly soon after you write it.

WA: It's like having a baby. When I was in the service I'd just finished writing or copying an arrangement when I had come down the next morning we'd have jazz band and I'd put it down, let's do it. You know what I'm saying? I did a lot of writing in the service. I remember the Warrant Officer, who was in charge of the band, subsequently went on and became Colonel Gabriel, the head of all the Air Force bands in Washington, after I left he went down to Washington. As I was getting out of the service he tried to stop me from taking my arrangements. And I had to go above his head and say this was not my CO, or whatever you call it, I forget what it was. This is not — I'm here as a trombone player. So if I did this writing I did it on my own time. I didn't do it on Air Force time so it doesn't belong to the Air Force, so I ended up taking all my arrangements. He wanted to keep them. Because he had started a little band or something and he wanted to keep all that music.

MR: It must have been pretty good then.

WA: But I didn't have much money so I sat around the barracks and I was writing music.

MR: Did you ever consider making a career out of the service?

WA: No. No. I mean Sammy Nestico did and I think Sammy Nestico has had a fantastic life. He stayed in the service twenty years. He went in very young and he came out and he just like blossomed. And so twenty years lost, if you think of it as lost in the service, for Sammy Nestico, they were really not lost, I mean he had a good job in Washington and everything else. But you have to know Sammy Nestico.

MR: Tell me about your first kind of road experience. Was it an eye opener? Were your parents, like, into it?

WA: Yeah, what happened is I had been down — oh when I left the Schillinger House this guy that was in the school wanted me to get a bunch of musicians together to go down to Myrtle Beach and play for the summer at this place down there. So we went down to this place and did some rehearsing and everything else. A lot of it was arrangements from a band we had in Hartford prior to me going. Oh, how I knew I wanted to write music, now we're getting a little off the track. When I was in high school I got called into the principal's office because I kept cutting my last period, a study hall. And so I'd go in — it wasn't every day, I think it was one day a week — and so I got called in front of the principal and the vice principal, Thomas Quirk and Mr. Allen, boy I'll never forget those names. I'll forget people's names I met yesterday but — and they sat down over me and I said, "You know I'm going over to the Hartford School of Music and I'm playing with this band of musicians that just got out of World War II that I'm learning a lot from, names you don't know, the leader was a guy by the name of — a very good arranger and trombone player — "Chick" Cicchetti from around Waterbury, Connecticut. And he just passed away a couple of years ago. But I says, "This is what I want to do. I'm learning. This is a learning thing for me over there instead of sitting in a study hall." They said, "Go for it." That's that thing. Now anyway, so I came back through New York after I had been to Myrtle Beach for the summer with the band leader, and this guy walked out on the band and never paid us. And my father had to send me money for a Greyhound bus. And I stopped off at this friend's house in New York and I stayed here for a while with him, he lived in the Village with his parents, who treated me just marvelous. And I went and auditioned for Charlie Spivak's band and I got the job. So I went out on the road with Charlie Spivak's band, now this is 1950 I guess. I got out of high school in June of '49, went to Boston in September of '49, yeah I guess it was in '50. And I went out on the road with Spivak's band and as a matter of fact a very famous vocalist was on that band, famous — maybe not big famous, you may not know the name, Lynn Roberts — she was on that band and I think I was 17 and she was like 15 and everybody thought she was 18. I'm serious. And she went on to sing with Tommy Dorsey and she became pretty well known. And we finally met after many years back in the New York Studio scene where she would become a jingle singer.

MR: What kind of money were you making?

WA: I was making — oh with Charlie Spivak I was making a hundred dollars a week. And I had to pay for my own hotel room. But the hotel rooms were for the most part anywhere between two and four dollars a night. You always roomed with somebody else, I mean you didn't have your own room. And maybe the room was like eight dollars, six dollars, something like that. Never over ten. And a lot of times with those bands, what you'd do is you'd finish a job at one o'clock in the morning and you'd drive all night to the next

place and you'd check in like eight o'clock in the morning and you'd get two nights for one.

MR: Oh yeah.

WA: You'd sleep all day and then sleep all night for one fee, providing the room was ready. So yeah, well it was the first time away from home, it was a big eye opener. I mean houses of prostitution in Athens, Georgia, and I was a young kid and the whole band takes me to this place.

MR: Really? Here's your education.

WA: Athens, Georgia. I'll never forget it. And you'd go in this room and all these women were sitting around the wall. Those vivid pictures you never forget.

MR: Wow. You just like point?

WA: Actually you did. You did. You decided which one you wanted. It was my first experience with any prostitute you know. I think needless to say they got my money and I failed. Anyways I was on that band, I don't know just before — I left to go in the Korean War. I got drafted to go in the Korean War so I left. And I was on the band probably a year at the most, not even that.

MR: Yeah. Mostly dances?

WA: Oh yeah. Bands in those days were playing public dances, which you don't see anymore, in a ballroom in Indiana or something like that, that all the bands went through, Lake Compounce, Connecticut, all the bands went through, and you'd play at officers clubs, NCO clubs in the service, and the big thing too bands did in those days, yeah, I remember that in this band, is you'd go into a college and you would play a dance on Friday night, a concert on Saturday afternoon and a dance Saturday night. So that was like a long weekend in a college. And colleges used to hired bands that way. As a matter of fact Kai Winding got wised up. Kai Winding was a very good businessman. He decided he was going to take his trombone band and compete with the big bands. So he started getting a lot of that work after he decided he didn't want to play the jazz clubs anymore. So he was jumping around playing these colleges, not all over the country but from here to the Mississippi River, generally that's where most of the business was. One time with Spivak we ended up in Texas I remember for like — and everything was done with a bus, not with Kai Winding but with Charlie Spivak it was a bus — anyways I came out of the service and I mean I could talk for a long, long time on the experience in Charlie Spivak's band and how I learned. You know I was young and I grew up with Dizzy Gillespie and Charlie Parker and everything else. Most of the guys in the band were a little older than that, right? So when I did get — I took Leon Cox's place as a matter of fact, I don't know if you know that name, but he was the guy that played the very, very famous trombone solo on Gene Krupa's record of "Lover." It's a very unusual solo. And

so when I moved up from third trombone to second trombone, when he left — I never did play first trombone in that band — I learned a lot from Vinnie Forchetti, who was playing first trombone in that band for the last part of the time I was on it. I learned a lot from him. But I had one guy in back of me who loved me dearly, he was kind of a jokester, his name was Buddy Hanna and everything else, and he played kind of like Sweets Edison you know and stuff like that. But he'd yell down at me and says, "Stop playing that Chinese music." I was hearing things bebop. And although I knew very little about harmony, I was doing everything by ear and everything else, that's what was coming out. That was my roots you see.

MR: Isn't that what Cab told Dizzy?

WA: Yeah.

MR: Stop playing that Chinese music?

WA: Yeah, yeah. I mean I do have opinions about that. I think if you're playing in a Dixieland band you don't play bebop. Some people feel they play the way they play no matter what they're playing. I think you have to try to kind of style — maybe you're prostituting yourself, I don't think so. I think you have to kind of play the style of the music you're playing in. You can't get — but I kind of learned that as I got older. I think I can play in a Dixieland band and I think I can play creative in a simpler harmonic way and still be creative and be happy with myself. Naturally I'd rather play with music that's a little more modern harmonically etc.

MR: Well you were in the Sauter-Finegan band, which was really kind of different from most.

WA: Well that certainly was a huge learning experience for me. I had just come out of the service and I auditioned in the same studio, Nola Studios, not the Nola Studios that exists now in New York, but it was a rehearsal studio, a famous rehearsal studio on Broadway around 52nd Street I think it was. And in the same studio I rehearsed, I went up and took an audition for the Sauter-Finegan band, they were looking for a trombone player, and I got the job. And I remember, I'll never forget, Eddie Sauter coming around with a questionnaire to everybody before they got up to sit in and play with the band, like, "What kind of music do you like," and, "who do you like musically." And I remember distinctly putting down Urbie Green, who was my idol, and probably Dizzy Gillespie for sure, and most likely Charlie Parker you know. And I got the job. And I had played the jazz chair on the Sauter-Finegan band, what jazz there was to play I got to do that. And they liked me. It was a wonderful time. I mean I could go on and talk and talk but the thing is, what made me leave the Sauter-Finegan band, and I did quit, was I got an offer to go play first trombone with Woody Herman's band and I had never had the opportunity to play first trombone except for in the Air Force I did certainly. And so — the money was actually less. I think Sauter-Finegan was playing a hundred fifty a week at

this time and Woody Herman was paying a hundred and twenty-five a week. No I was making a hundred fifty with Woody Herman. I think the money was about the same to tell you the truth. But it wasn't that much money to make that much difference. And Kay Finegan, Bill Finegan's wife, was extremely insulted when I left the band.

MR: Oh really?

WA: She says, "You're going to leave us to go with that band?" And I can understand, because she had such a love for her husband and such a passion for their music, and their music was great. It was — everything was great. It was great. But the thing I didn't like about it was there was no freedom except when you had a jazz solo, which wasn't that often. But all the nuances were written in and you had to play them exactly as written. You couldn't take any liberty with the crescendo, and it was either vibrato or no vibrato, it was like playing in a symphony orchestra.

MR: I was just going to say, very classical.

WA: Yeah. It wasn't classical music, but the thing is they approached it like an orchestra. And you had to play like you were in an orchestra. And Woody Herman, I've always, I mean I've always fantasized about Woody Herman's band so I had this opportunity to play and I'll never forget when I joined Woody Herman's band it was on New Year's Eve, December 31, 1955, or the beginning of '56. And we played this TV show in Philadelphia, live, a live TV show, we were on the air about a solid hour or something like that, and I don't think it was network TV but anyways, Woody, I'm playing first trombone sight reading, sight reading.

MR: On the television show.

WA: Cy Touf was playing second trombone, I mean but he played the bass trumpet, and he wasn't strong enough sound-wise to play lead, and Bobby Lamb was playing third trombone, who is a very good trombone player but he was kind of green then. I think he was kind of green then. He was a very good trombone player. He's matured. I don't know if you know the name, Bobby Lamb. He's a very good trombone player that lives in England. But Bobby would get so drunk that the cops couldn't understand him when they'd pick him up in the street so they'd put him in jail because they couldn't understand his English. He had this thick Irish brogue. He landed in jail because the cops couldn't understand him. Anyways, so I played first trombone, that was the trombone section, Bobby Lamb and myself. And that first night Woody calls up "Four Others." Now "Four Others" is written for four trombones. We only had three trombones. But they play it, to this day I think, I don't know if they play it anymore, but in those days they played it with one of the tenor saxophone players playing one of the trombone parts, which plays an inside part, it works. So I did this thing and I was like sweating bullets. So after the show Woody came over to me and he said, "Man that was the greatest piece of sight

reading I've ever witnessed," he says, "that was terrific." And I said, "Well I wasn't sight reading, Woody," I said, "I'd heard that record so many times that I knew what was coming." You know I'd heard and listened to the record. When you know what's coming you're not really reading. So then I was on Woody's band through pretty much up until June or July of '56. And somewhere around March or April Bill Harris came back to the band. And he came back to the band playing second trombone. I guess he was just getting back into playing, he was getting his chops together and everything else. But Bill was one of the most incredible trombone players and I've ever experienced in my life. I mean this guy was the epitome of a great jazz trombone player. But he couldn't play second trombone. He couldn't do anything the way I did it. You know what I mean?

MR: Right. He was not a follower?

WA: It wasn't anything personal, you know. So I finally went to Woody. Because Bill had always played first trombone in that band. And I finally went to Woody and I says, "You know Woody, — maybe it'd be better for the band if Bill plays first trombone and I follow him." Well it worked and it was great. Except for those new pieces that Bill didn't know, and then it was a problem with his time because — he had wonderful time but by the time the thing went from here to here to here it came out late because he was an admittedly bad reader. So if he was reading something he knew it was like on the money. But if he was sight reading something it was like — anyways — and Bill was the one that said to me, "Wayne, when I left the band—" and Bill Harris, without telling me this, because Kai Winding and J.J. Johnson were around the corner in Philadelphia. We were working at Pep's and they were around the corner, I forget the name of that club there, and I didn't know Kai but Bill certainly did. And it was Bill that recommended me to Kai for his group. So that's when Kai called me. That's when I left Woody's band and Bill Harris said to me he says, "Wayne, the way you read and everything else, whatever you do don't stay out here, go to New York and go in the studios. Because that's where you're going to make the money."

MR: And you took that advice.

WA: And he hadn't been successful at it. He had been — matter of fact he is on some of those Sauter-Finegan studio recordings, Bill Harris, because he was around New York. But he hadn't been successful at the studio thing only because of his reading, and his individuality too. You know he couldn't play like Tommy Dorsey. He could only play like Bill Harris. And back in the days in the studios when you first came to New York in the studios and you have to play any kind of written solo it really had to be in the tradition of Tommy Dorsey.

MR: So you did some arranging for the trombone group with Kai. And how many trombones was that?

WA: Thanks to Bill Harris. Bill said, "Kai is going to do a record," he says, "sit down and write an original piece of music." And I did and it was the first original piece — not the first original piece, I shouldn't say, I did some in the service, but I didn't do a whole lot of original pieces. But I wrote this piece called, I named it "Nutcracker." And I only named it "Nutcracker" — I don't know what made me name it "Nutcracker." Because Connecticut is the Nutmeg State I think, isn't it? I think Connecticut is the Nutmeg State. And whether I had Connecticut on my mind or whether when I was writing this piece I thought this might be a ballbuster to play and I called it "Nutcracker," I don't really know why I called it "Nutcracker," but I called it "Nutcracker" anyways. And Kai liked it. Recorded it on the first record. As a matter of fact he liked it so much that it was — when we'd finished doing the album, and I don't have the videotape of this but I have the audiotape, we finished doing the album and before we went on the road we were on the Steve Allen Show, which was The Tonight Show then. And we did two tunes, "Nutcracker" and that thing we did with the [humms] from "Carousel" — "Little Girl" was it? The tune from "Carousel." And we were — because Steve Allen made mention that we were going to this club in Philadelphia, back to this club in Philadelphia called Pep's, where I had been with Woody Herman. It was an active club in Philadelphia in those days. And I did that and I did some more things. I think the things that I did that were recorded, I did "The Preacher" which was a simple arrangement. It wasn't a copy of Horace Silver's arrangement, but it certainly had Horace Silver's inspiration behind it. But it wasn't a copy of Horace Silver's arrangement. Especially, there was a shout chorus and everything else that was totally different from Horace Silver's arrangement. But I loved that record of Horace Silver's, "The Preacher," so I did that. And then I did some other things, I can't quite remember what they were. But then we started playing jazz clubs pretty much exclusively. We'd go to a place and be there a week or two or something like that. We went to a place, Porky's Hideaway in Florida and we were there for like a month just playing jazz music. And then — I don't know if it was before Carl left or not but Kai decided that he wanted to make more money. So that's when we decided, I started to do a lot of writing, Dick Lieb and myself, of just standard tunes. He wanted a lot of tunes, we were going to play dances. So there was just like any tune, I don't know, and just harmonize it and then go on to another tune. It was no fancy arranging, it was just a tune. And I think Carl — Carl doesn't like to stay with one thing too long anyways, no matter what it is, but I think Carl left around this time and that's when Don Sebesky came on. And Don Sebesky came on the group, I remember it was in the summertime because Don was out of school. He went to the Manhattan School of Music and he came on the group for the summertime, and Don was the one that told me, he says, "Wayne," he says, "you should go to school. You should go to the Manhattan

School of Music." I don't know if he said Manhattan, but that's where he was going anyways. And he went back I think to school in September and left, and this trombone player, a very good trombone player from Cincinnati came on and took his place called Ola Hanson. And no he's from Columbus. And it was while Ola was on the band that I left the group to settle in New York. It was in February of '58. I came in for the second semester of school because I was on the verge. I'm a depression baby you know, so I was going to lose my GI bill if I didn't get in school on time so I wasn't going to lose that money. So I decided I'd better get in school you know. So I got in school and the government paid all my education at the Manhattan School of Music and I stayed there and I graduated in 1962 and that's — I was around town and I was, I think I graduated, I'd taken some kind of exam and what knowledge I'd learned at Berklee helped me. I think I skipped a grade or something. I think I only went to Manhattan School and got a degree in about three years time. I think I went to summer school a bit too. And so then I was around town, I got the job at CBS, I was doing the Jackie Gleason Show and everything else. Then the next thing that comes was Gerry Mulligan's concert jazz band. Then, not a turning point, but the big thing that happened is when I was asked to go to Russia with Benny Goodman's band. 1962.

MR: That must have been an experience.

WA: [whistles].

MR: Who else was that — Flip Phillips?

WA: No.

MR: This was a big band.

WA: It was Zoot Sims, Tommy Newsom, I think Gene Allen was playing baritone, Phil Woods and Jerry Dodgion was playing second alto. Trombone were Jimmy Knepper, Willie Dennis and myself. Trumpets were Jimmy Maxwell, Joe Newman, Joe Wilder and Johnny Frosk. And the rhythm section was Mel Lewis, bass was Bill Crow and the piano was John Bunch. And the other piano player, who unfortunately didn't get to play very much, Teddy Wilson. Can you believe that? He didn't get to play. Benny wouldn't let him play you know. After about a week he decided that he wanted to use John on everything. And Teddy was brought along really to play with his trio. But anyways we won't go there. Oh and Turk VanLake was playing guitar, right. And we had this woman singer, Joya Sherrill, who had been with Duke Ellington's band. That was the whole band.

MR: Oh yeah, Joya Sherrill. Well does he live up to his reputation? Did he live up to his reputation on that trip?

WA: Who?

MR: Benny.

WA: Oh. Well I don't know how far you want me to go. Have you ever read Bill Crow's?

MR: Yeah. I love it.

WA: Well I think pretty much whatever Bill Crow said hit it right on the head. The only thing, and I don't think it was deliberate, I always felt that that should have come out before Benny died. But I mean maybe it just worked out time-wise that way. I think Benny should have had an opportunity to read it. I remember it coming out shortly after Benny died. Benny was not a chameleon. He was not a jive-ass you know. What you saw is what you got. And what you saw you didn't like a lot of times, because he could be snakey and he could be — I remember we were in Sochi in the Black Sea and we had been in Moscow for a week and we finally got to Sochi where the sun was and all the girls on the beach, and he calls a rehearsal like at twelve noon. And we were rehearsing. I think without exaggeration he stood over Phil Woods and the saxophone section but primarily over Phil Woods for almost an hour rehearsing the first chord of "Let's Dance." And he finally turned down, looked at Phil and he says, "You're supposed to learn how to do that in high school." So then we go back to the hotel that night, we had a big party, I don't know who's room it was in, we were drinking a lot of vodka and everything and I remember Phil going out on the porch and — can I use the F word?

MR: Sure you can.

WA: He goes out on the porch, "Fuck the king." And that was in Sochi. And it was — I don't know, I hate to talk, I could tell you, I don't want to, there are some real dark things I could say that I don't want to go to because it's not that I have never said them to anybody but I don't know if I want to say it on tape.

MR: Well I know he didn't make a lot of friends on that trip. I've talked to some of the guys who were on that tour.

WA: Well yeah. I don't think there's anybody in the band that was certainly — you know ironically if anybody in that band, and I'm thinking about everybody in the band now, if anybody had something nice to say about Benny and not dark and negative, it was Teddy Wilson. Teddy Wilson wasn't getting to play at all and — hardly at all — and he was as mild in manner, he was a gentleman. I mean this is like, Teddy Wilson was a first class cat man. And I don't know, there are certain things that could have been better on the part of the musicians themselves. It became like — in a way it became a little bit like a revolution going on too. Well let's start the ball going. Okay? I had, first of all, I wasn't initially supposed to go at all. Jimmy Knepper got the mumps and he couldn't go to the World's Fair and to Seattle. That was the first gig first, because of the mumps. And so Benny called Lou Schoobe who was the contractor at CBS to find out if I could get a break from the Gary Moore Show and Schoobe said no, I couldn't go. Or maybe he called me and I asked, I can't remember all that. So Benny, well I mean it's a feather in

my cap I guess but this is what was told to me, I mean it was told to me by the contractor at CBS, not by Benny, that Benny went to Paley, William Paley. He went to the CEO, and said I want this guy and tell the contractor to let him go. So I mean it makes me feel good that somebody wanted me that much to go through all that trouble. And so that made me feel good. So from that standpoint it's hard to badmouth someone — but anyways, so I went. And some kid that was playing third trombone, he was a teacher and I don't know how he got hooked up with the Benny thing and everything else, but we went out to Seattle and the World's Fair and everything else. We came back to New York and Jimmy Knepper re-joined the band. And this kid left. Instead of me going, this kid left. I stayed on the band. So I forget — what was the question relating to this? Was there? I just can't remember.

MR: Well I just said he didn't seem to make any friends on that particular tour.

WA: Oh I know what it is. So he had told me over the phone. I didn't have anything written, no nothing written. He told me over the phone he'd pay me $500 a week. And back in those days, back in '62, that was a good sum of money. So I certainly said yes obviously. I go to get my first paycheck and it's $400. And the reason it's $400 is — I don't know if Benny told me this himself, I can't remember, or if the secretary, Muriel Zuckerman told me, I'm not sure, but it came from him anyways — he said 500 because he thought I was going to have to pay for my hotel. And now that I didn't have to pay for my hotel he was going to pay me 400. Well he knew. He knew that we weren't going to have to pay for our hotel room. But see the old style of band musicians, the Charlie Spivak, the Tommy Dorseys and all back in those days before 1962, the musicians always paid for their own hotel. You got a salary, you pay for your hotel. So that was kind of dirty pool. And I can't remember, I can't remember to tell you the truth, to be honest about it, I can't remember if he pulled this on other people. But right away he got off on a bad foot. And then, so Jimmy Knepper is playing first trombone and doing a good job of playing first trombone, and all of a sudden Benny doesn't want him to play first trombone, he wants me to play first trombone. So all of a sudden Jimmy Knepper is playing third trombone. And I think Jimmy didn't show me any hostility. It wasn't my doings or anything like that. But he'd play games like that with musicians. He kind of pitted musicians one against one another. He created the dissention himself in the band. And I think a lot of it, sometimes you wonder about it, if everybody was put on edge so much so that he would sound better. I don't know.

MR: Could be.

WA: I mean people that were there hearing this or seeing this might disagree with me but that's sometimes the way I felt.

MR: Well didn't he sometimes take solos away from people if they were getting too much recognition.

WA: Oh, definitely. I mean Joya Sherrill, well now I'll tell you a true story. Joya Sherrill is a lovely looking woman, a good vocalist, had good credits, sang with Duke Ellington and everything else. A wonderful person. And the Russians loved her. And she was coming out and she was doing like three or four songs a concert. And he kept cutting her down. By the end of the tour she was doing one tune a concert. Well that's an insult to a vocalist, to come out and do one tune on a whole concert, one tune. You know, at least two. But I mean she would start out doing four or five and now she's down to one. So it was obvious Benny didn't like the idea that she was getting so much love from the audience. You know she was. So we got to the airport in Paris on the way home, we were kind of all splitting up. I was staying in Paris with John Bunch and most of the guys were going home and Benny was going to the Swiss bank in Zurich, we were all splitting up. So Joya goes over to Benny, this is something, Joya goes over the Benny and taps him on the shoulder and says, I was standing right there, she says, "I think you picked up my camera by mistake." He turns around and looks at the camera and he says, "Oh yeah." And he drops it on the floor. I mean he didn't break it. I won't say he broke it. But the point is he didn't hand it to her, he just dropped it on the floor and walked away. Another famous story that's been told forty thousand times about the rehearsal, I think the true story of this was Lynn Roberts, the singer that was singing with Benny, this was before this, when they were rehearsing up at his house in Connecticut in his back barn or wherever he used to rehearse. You heard that story?

MR: It was so cold or something?

WA: Yeah. It was so cold, and she says, "Benny it's getting cold in here." So he says, "Oh yeah." So he goes in and puts a jacket on and comes back out. That's kind of an eccentric story.

MR: Well I know one trumpet player that was on that tour who will not say the name Benny Goodman, he was so upset at how that tour went that — he'll say —

WA: Well that's obviously Joe Wilder.

MR: He'll say, "The clarinet player."

WA: Well he treated Joe really badly. His reason for treating Joe badly was that Benny has this crazy way of thinking that somebody's using him. And Joe had a lot of excess luggage due to the fact that he was going from Russia to Sweden to meet his wife, because she's Swedish and he wasn't coming home, so he had all this luggage he was carrying around or something, I'm not quite sure.

MR: Yeah, plus his cameras.

WA: But there was some hostility over this and Benny was kind of rubbing him, trying to deduct money from his pay for overweight luggage and all kinds of stuff and it was so dumb because the government was paying it all. The United States government was paying this thing. It was a State Department tour. It wasn't a free enterprise thing sponsored by Benny Goodman or a producer or something. And I've never heard Joe Wilder in my life swear, but I heard him swear behind me on that trip. Not anything really profane, but —

MR: For Joe.

WA: But Joe was sitting right in back of me you know.

MR: Enough said I guess.

WA: I mean there's other stories I could tell you, it was so dark I don't even want to go there.

MR: Well let me talk about this studio scene that you had a big part in. And I was curious about the racial make-up of the studio bands at the time and did it change and is it still changing?

WA: It changed drastically. When I first came into New York the studio musicians, the studio bands, there was no set studio band it was just a bunch of freelance players that were hired for different sessions etcetera, etcetera, were very integrated.

MR: This was what year then?

WA: I came to New York in February of '62 and I got kind of active in the studio work, it wasn't very long after that, maybe '63. It took me about a year to get ingrained in the thing. And the rhythm section in those days, the first call rhythm section was Milt Hinton, Osie Johnson and Hank Jones. I mean I'm not saying they did everything but that was pretty much THE rhythm section. But in those days everything in the studios, whether it be a jingle or a recording, all was based on swing music. I mean the only time you'd play a straight eighth note is if you did some thing that was like a cha-cha or a commercial record, something like a cha-cha or something like that. You know, this was before rock & roll. And when rock & roll started coming in, except for some drummers and of course there were some exceptions like Jon Faddis, the studio bands became more white. There were more white musicians — in the ratio, to black musicians. I don't know why that was. There was one thing in studio music, I must admit, and I'm not trying to say here, and I hope it's not misconstrued, that, and I'm not looking to say this was the reason, but there was a time in studio music where you'd be playing rock & roll but you'd be playing swing kind of rhythmentation, like Blood, Sweat & Tears, let's say Blood, Sweat & Tears. But it's all written in sixteenth notes. Now, and there was a long period in the studios where everything was done in sixteenth notes instead of eighth notes.

MR: Really?

WA: Oh yeah, oh sure. [scats], which is eighth-quarter-eighth, all of a sudden became [scats] sixteenth-eighth-sixteenth. So if you've got a very complicated rhythmic figure, that wasn't really that complicated but it was all in sixteenth notes, it was a little harder to decipher. And the people that deciphered it faster and didn't have to think about it much were obviously the people that were noticed and worked more. Now I don't know what to say about it, and I'm not saying that was the reason there was more white musicians doing that work. I mean it may have something to do, and I hope it's not misconstrued, it may have something to do with the education.

MR: Yeah. Perhaps more of the white players went through the college.

WA: Went through the college, or the way, having been exposed more to Arban studies, or I don't know what to say you know. But that was one thing. But I noticed generally speaking in my last years in playing studio music that the musicians weren't as integrated, in proportion, ratios, as it had been in the past.

MR: That's interesting because it seems like it kind of went in a circle then. Because before Milt Hinton and those fellas, it's my understanding that the studio musicians were almost exclusively white.

WA: That's true. That's before my time.

MR: Right. So then when you got in it it was more integrated, then it went the other way.

WA: Yeah. I think you're talking about — what you're talking about is the Tommy Dorsey era, the fallout of the Paul Whiteman band. That's the thing. Paul Whiteman was a white band. And the King of Jazz and all that stuff, and we know he wasn't of course but a lot of those musicians ended up being premier studio musicians in the thing — Jimmy Dorsey, Tommy Dorsey, Klein, and you're right. I didn't think about that but it's true. And anyways —

MR: Well you're writing, you say you're doing an awful lot more writing now.

WA: Yeah as a matter of fact Bill Watrous called me just last night, my wife answered the phone and says — my wife answered and he says, "Tell Wayne it's God."

MR: Sounds like him.

WA: So he calls me quite often but he had just picked up this new ITA Journal where I'd gotten a really good review from the Brass Conference. Bill Spilka wrote this article, I mean this is a big — it said that my band, and we followed the One O'Clock North Texas Band. We followed them. And Bill Spilka wrote, it said that this band that Wayne Andre got together, and the music — I haven't seen the article, Bill was reading it to me — is the best thing that happened at the Brass Conference.

MR: All right. Excellent.

WA: I think part of it was when I went up on stage after the North Texas Band breaking down I told them I don't want to use all these microphones. Get rid of all these microphones. I can't stand that sound.

MR: Isn't that something?

WA: I can't stand that everybody's got to have a mic, I can't stand it. The music is written so that it will sound okay without the microphone. If you've got a flute solo and it's overly orchestrated and you can't hear the flute it's your fault. I mean a recording session is different. But if you're writing live music you've got to write live music that acoustically sounds right. And you learn that.

MR: Right. And let the players balance.

WA: I did a concert, I'll never forget this, I did a concert and I had a big solo in the concert. I did a concert with Tony Bennett at Carnegie Hall. And on the first half of the concert was Robert Farnum and we were doing the music from "Porgy & Bess." And I just have to tell you the story how I ended up getting this solo because Buddy Morrow was actually the first trombone player but this thing, Buddy came across it and Buddy is a wonderful, wonderful cat but this thing for some reason came across written in the alto clef or some damn thing like that. And it was a spooky solo because the whole band stopped and you go, now listen carefully, [scats] you modulate right at the top [scats]. And it modulates right away and it was something that's beautiful but you kind of had to either hear it or read it. So Buddy says, "Man, why don't you play this thing?" So that's how I ended up getting the solo you know. And after the rehearsal I saw all these microphones, Robert Farnum, I didn't know Robert Farnum at all. I says, "You know this is Carnegie Hall. This music is so beautifully orchestrated. All these microphones are going to ruin the music." He said, "Oh no, we don't need any microphones, what are you talking about, microphones?" So because of me, all the microphones, I don't know if they were taken down but they were shut off. And that concert was a big success concert. I'm not saying I was the reason it was a big success but I'm just saying that I hate music that sounds like over — anyways the North Texas Band, I said I don't want any micro — we'll have one microphone solo for a trumpet solo or just maybe two or three solo mics and that's all we need. And my music that I write and that I played on that concert by and large — I have to be careful I don't give myself too many accolades, but most of it, each piece is different. Each piece is different and the first piece doesn't sound like the fourth piece. Like I did this real production number and it came out really terrific, "My Man's Gone Now" and this was kind of maybe the highlight of the concert. And then we ended up doing the thing I wrote for Doc Severinsen which actually Bill Watrous recorded with Danny Styles, that piece "Ayo," that kind of ended the concert. But the thing is, I haven't

heard a lot of college bands. But that night with the North Texas band, and it's a great band, it's always fifth gear. The energy.

MR: It's like getting beat on the head.

WA: It's just like give me a break. And it's good, but the energy level is constant. It's not—

MR: So probably when your group came on it was like everybody's ears were able to relax and really listen.

WA: And plus it was more acoustic sounding because the microphones were taken away. And I think that had a lot to do with the article that Bill Spilka wrote in the ITA Journal.

MR: Let me play a couple of little excerpts of albums you've played on, some of which are really my favorites.

[audio interlude]

Do you recall this?

WA: The Accidentals?

MR: No. See this is like a personal blindfold test. It's a Don Sebesky date. Well I'll just have to tell you, this is Jackie & Roy.

WA: Oh okay, okay, I remember, yeah.

MR: Really a great sounding record.

WA: Oh I know it. I mean Don is a master. Have you interviewed him yet?

MR: No, I'm working on it.

WA: Oh yeah. He's a master. I thank Don a lot because he was actually — I learned more about music from this one teacher at the Manhattan School of Music than anybody I've ever learned in my life except for great players I sat next to like Brookmeyer and people like that. But I have to thank Don because he was the one the guy who told me to go back to school. And I went back to school because he thought it was the thing to do and that's what I did. And I studied with this one teacher, Yolanda Eulayla. Eulayla is her last name. She taught composition at the Manhattan School of Music. And I wasn't a composition major, much to my regret today I wasn't, it's just that when I went back to school I knew, I felt that I was going to be busy playing the trombone, and to be a composition major takes a lot of time and work and I felt it was going to take me too far away from my trombone. You have to put a lot of time into it. And Don was a composition major.

MR: Well let me try this one on you.

[audio interlude]

I don't think the brass is in right away but —

WA: That's the saxophone player that played with Dave Brubeck.

MR: That's right. That's Paul Desmond.

WA: Paul Desmond, right, yeah. Yeah I remember doing that, yeah.

MR: And here's one more.

[audio interlude]

WA: Jaco.

MR: Yeah.

WA: Yeah I'll never forget that band.

MR: I'll bet. Was that a scene or what? A different kind of Benny Goodman scene?

WA: No it was totally different. I mean there was a lot of love between the musicians in that band. There was a lot of camaraderie. Benny had a lot of musicians kind of divided in the band too you know. There was a lot of love in the musicians and there was a lot of love for Jaco, it's just that I mean Jaco was just Jaco. He was just a crazy person. I mean like Jaco took his bass threw it in a lake in Japan, and he did it so the Japanese people would go diving for it and get it back. That's how much vanity he had. And he'd walk around the bullet train — I'm talking dark things, negative things about him. Musically he was a genius. I mean musically, the thing that amazed me about Jaco was the only other person I ever saw that could lose one like he could was Bob Brookmeyer but he could lose one and boy he'd just know where one is all the time. Randy Brecker can too, and Michael, but not many players I know can really lose one and know exactly where it is. You know what I mean by that?

MR: Yeah. In their own solo.

WA: Yeah, right.

MR: Not be playing over the bar line kind of.

WA: He always started out, like we had this party in Tokyo when we first got there and Woody Herman was there with Flip Phillips and Al Cohn and I don't know if Zoot was there. All-star Woody Herman band or some pick-up band. And Kai Winding was there with J.J. Johnson. It was a big thing in Japan where we all came together at the end in Yokohama and put on this huge concert. But after this feast, it was a feast, we all went our separate ways on the road so to speak in Japan, and then we all met at the end of about a week's time in Yokohama and put on this big concert. So sure enough everybody's seated down and everybody's like it was very formal too, speeches and everything else, so Jaco comes in after everybody is sat down, I think after it even started, he's like dressed in Indian war paint with a band around his head. And Woody Herman said to me, milling around the sushi and everything else after the speeches, Woody says, "Who in the hell is this guy you're with?" I don't think Woody knew him. I don't know if he knew of him from before with the Weather Report or not, I don't know, but he was adored, as well he should have been musically, by the people in Japan. He could do no wrong. And I mean he did outrageous things like writing on the windows of the bullet train in magic marker, I mean you know, give me a break. I mean that's like kid stuff you

know what I mean? And the last thing I want to say about Jaco, because I thought the world of him musically and I thought the world of him personally too, deep down he was a really nice, generous, giving person. As a matter of fact I was a nobody on the band compared to Randy Brecker and Faddis and those people. And one night just he and I hung out together. He wasn't into this — he was like — he wasn't into this thing of just hanging out with his star soloists, you know like Mintzer and Randy Brecker and Faddis, etcetera, etcetera. But anyways, one of the last times I saw Jaco, because I did do things when I came back to him, little things we did down in the Village in New York with him the last sad time that I think I remember seeing him I came up out of the subway at 42nd Street and Seventh Avenue and it was for a ten o'clock session at this studio called Automated, it used to be a very busy studio in New York at 1500 Broadway right there on the east side of Broadway. So I'm crossing the road and Jaco's out there, this is hard to believe this but this is a true story, he's out there with the records out of the jackets, I don't know if they were ever in the jackets but with the plastic vinyl records, the LPs, like this. This is in rush hour traffic coming down Seventh Avenue. He's slinging them into traffic. Bouncing them off cars. Who knows why. Maybe it was something he just needed — you ever read the book on him?

MR: I have not read it yet.

WA: The book is terrific. I can't remember who wrote the book but the book is fascinating. Maybe he just needed attention so badly, I don't know, he needs love or attention, but he needed something. So I took him, I took him up, he was dirty, he'd been up all night, he was dirty, and I said, "Well come on over the studio and see some of the guys," I said "Randy'll probably be there or something like that." So he went with me over to the studio and I took him into the bathroom to get him cleaned up a bit at the sink there and everything. So he looked terrible. So I took twenty dollars out of my pocket and gave it to him. He took the twenty dollars and started putting me down for giving him twenty dollars. He took the twenty and he says, "What the hell do you think I am" or something. But I could see he was down and out and I wanted to do a little bit to help him. It wasn't three hundred dollars, it was twenty dollars. So I remember he came out there in the hall there for a while and said hello to a couple of the musicians and then we had to go in to work and he just kind of disappeared and I never saw him after that. He disappeared and I never saw him after that.

MR: Wow. Fascinating. Sad. Let me wrap up here by asking if September 11th changed your life much, either from a music standpoint or in any other regards.

WA: That's a hard one. I mean I really don't think so. Maybe I should see my analyst to be sure. I'm only kidding. I mean it was a terrible thing, an awful thing, as a matter of fact I'll never forget the first phone call, well the first phone call that I got that morning, and I

had seen it on television, as a matter of fact it may have been happening, no it had just happened when I talked to this person, Al Porcino called me from Munich, Germany. Do you know the name Al Porcino?

MR: Sure.

WA: He says, "Wayne, what's—" And I don't know Al Porcino that well. He says "Wayne, what's going on over there? What in the world is this going on?" And we talked and talked and talked and talked. I says "Al, I don't know, but I remember last night I subbed on Toshiko's band and I remember seeing Jake Hanna at the bar and I remember seeing Jake Hanna dumping martinis down, and I'm wondering what in the hell he's thinking about this morning. I never have spoken to Jake to find out, with this hangover he must have had with this going. One thing is being sober, but this thing is, but anyway Al Porcino called me because what happened is that as I say we don't know one another that well. I mean we know each other professionally but he had recorded, I was over in Europe with Tom Harrell's octet and he was in Munich the night we were there in this club and he had his tape recorder running. And I remember that night I felt good, I was on. Some nights I didn't feel so good. But that night I felt really good about my playing. So actually I got his address from John Mosca and I wrote to him in 1997 to ask him if he would send me a copy of this tape. I never heard from him. Finally in 2001 he sends me this tape. He says "Oh I just came across this on my desk." So I had received a tape and I can't remember if I — I think I wrote him back to thank him for sending me the tape and had just heard from me so I was the closest one right after this happened, yeah. My son's mother's husband's daughter's husband, they haven't found him yet. Now my son wasn't really close to this guy but he knows pretty well his wife, but that's the only close connection I have with anybody that was there. But as far as the music business goes I don't think it's changed the music business. It certainly hasn't changed the music business for me. I mean it was a big thing with cutting salaries on Broadway for a while which I don't really want to get into, but I think our union was a little intimidated by the stagehand union who always have a job. Musicians don't always have a job. And when "Phantom of the Opera" and "Les Miserables" and I'm not there so I shouldn't criticize what I don't know, but when they're making millions and millions of dollars and not passing the profits down to the musicians, all of a sudden they start to lose money, they want musicians to be their partner?

MR: Right.

WA: And it didn't last very long, because business came back. And I think actually I don't know the whole truth behind the thing but I think maybe what money they withheld, the president of our union said we'll cut the salary by twenty-five percent. But anyway I don't want to go there because I wasn't there so I don't really under— No I don't really,

to be totally honest about the thing I'm really occasionally I'll get, like I'm on Ricky Martin "She Bangs."

MR: Oh what?

WA: "She Bangs" by Ricky Martin.

MR: Oh, okay. Yeah.

WA: I remember in the studio, I'm in the studio and I've got this music in front of me it says "She Bangs," and like I'm the oldest guy in the horn section of the thing and I says, "Jesus, when I was a kid," I said, "I never heard that expression." I says, "The expression I heard when I was a kid was she gang bangs." And I couldn't believe that this thing was actually going to come out under that title. And all of a sudden the record came out and it's called "She Bangs." Right? That was the tune. And so I'm up at the beach in Rhode Island and these little kids around me and their father and everything else, and I said I did this Ricky Martin, "You worked with Ricky Martin?" he said. So I had to tell the father like yeah it was — and then the thing becomes the biggest hit in the country. I mean it's like a monster hit you know. "She Bangs."

MR: Well this has really been fascinating talking to you.

WA: Yeah, likewise.

MR: I appreciate it. And best of luck with your writing.

WA: I hope I didn't get too — I can get long winded you know, I like to talk.

MR: That's all right. Best of luck with your new charts.

WA: Well thank you. As a matter of fact when I was in Rhode Island this past week I wrote a whole exposition on a new piece. I'm rehearsing in two weeks again. I like to rehearse once a month. I like to go into every rehearsal and have something new. If it's not finished, at least in progress you know.

MR: All right. I'll look forward to it.

WA: All right. Thanks.